



State of Ohio Administrative Policy

Use of State Buildings

No:
OPF-001

Effective:
January 12, 2024

Appointing Authority Approval:

Kathleen C. Madden, Director

I. Purpose

To provide direction, active regulation, and control of all activities, decorations, and displays permitted in facilities managed by the Department of Administrative Services (DAS). This policy affects all DAS managed facilities (the Facilities) including: 30 East Broad Street, Columbus, Ohio; 77 South High Street, Columbus, Ohio; 246 N. High Street, Columbus, Ohio; 35 East Chestnut Street, Columbus, Ohio; 25 South Front Street, Columbus, Ohio; 4200 Surface Road, Columbus, Ohio; 1320 Arthur E. Adams Drive, Columbus, Ohio; 8895 E. Main Street, Reynoldsburg, Ohio; and 615 W. Superior Avenue, Cleveland, Ohio.

II. Scope

This policy applies to all tenants of the Facilities and to all members of the public who enter the Facilities. This policy does not apply to any activities conducted by DAS in the Facilities.

III. Policy

The Facilities are places of business for its tenants and members of the public with business with the Facility tenants. This Policy is designed to ensure the safety of all Facility tenants and guests, to provide all Facility tenants and guests with orderly access to the Facilities, and to keep the Facilities clean and professional in appearance.

A. General Use

1. The primary purpose of the lobby and public reception areas of the Facilities is to serve as an entry way to the building. The use of the lobbies and public reception

areas of the Facilities is restricted to the conduct of state business and to other activities the principal purpose of which is to improve the efficiency of a Facility tenant in achieving its objectives or to promote the health, safety, welfare, morale, education, or training of state employees. In addition to the usual business of state government, such activities may include state employee recognition ceremonies and DAS-sponsored charitable campaign programs, employee wellness programs, and similar activities.

2. The use of the office space of any Facility tenant is reserved exclusively for the employees, clients/customers, contractors, and visitors of the Facility tenant and subject to the control of the Facility tenant to the extent not inconsistent with this policy or an applicable lease.

B. Proposed Use of The Lobby or Public Reception Areas

1. In limited instances, the lobby and public reception areas of the Facilities may be used by Facility tenants for pre-approved activities that benefit State of Ohio employees. Facility tenants are required to submit a formal request to the DAS Facility Manager for any proposed use of the lobby or public reception areas of the Facilities (See Section VII).
2. A request shall include the name and title of the person completing the application, the proposed activities, the purpose of the proposed activities, the proposed date(s) and times of the planned activities, the proposed set-up, and the expected number of people involved.
3. The Facility Manager may deny a request for any reason and may cancel a request even after the applicant has begun using the Facility.

C. Prohibited Activities. The following activities are prohibited in the lobbies or public reception areas of the Facilities:

1. Private social activities, regardless of type or content.
2. Serving or consuming alcoholic beverages.
3. Serving or distributing food, food products, or non-alcoholic beverages regardless of the nature or reason for the distribution, unless approved pursuant to a request submitted under Section III.B.
4. Solicitation of any kind, including the solicitation of contributions, gifts or donations, the solicitation of signatures on petitions, and the solicitation of support for any political candidate or cause. This rule shall not prevent solicitation in connection with State of Ohio charitable fundraisers or events.
5. Distributing pamphlets, brochures, or printed materials other than in connection with activities approved pursuant to Section III.B.
6. Any activity that obstructs the free ingress or egress of those wishing to enter or leave the Facility.
7. A sound level, noise, or any other activity that disrupts the business of government in the public building.

8. Distributing free products or merchandise for any purpose, unless approved pursuant to a request submitted under Section III.B.
9. Display of a booth, table, or kiosk for any purpose other than an activity approved pursuant to Section III.B.
10. Affixing anything by any means to a wall, ceiling, counter, window, or door.
11. Display or use of any equipment or device that requires electricity other than equipment or those items that are State owned and used for an official purpose.
12. Carrying firearms in any State building except by individuals authorized to do so as peace officers or by other position of employment that requires the carrying of a firearm, and only in connection with their official duties.
13. Carrying any other type of deadly weapon.
14. Wood, metal, or plastic poles or standards including those used to support signs or banners.
15. Smoking, vaping, or the use of any tobacco products, except in those areas that have specifically been designated as smoking areas.
16. No animals or pets of any kind are permitted in the Facilities except to accommodate persons under the Americans with Disabilities Act and any other applicable laws.
17. Any other activity that presents a significant likelihood of damage to the public building.

- D. **Failure to Comply:** The Facility Manager has the authority to bar or evict any persons who fail to comply with the requirements of this Policy in any way.

IV. Definitions

None

V. Authority

Ohio Revised Code 123.01(A)(8)

VI. Resources

None

VII. Inquiries

Direct inquiries about this policy to:

State Chief Facilities Officer
General Services Division
Ohio Department of Administrative Services
30 East Broad Street
Columbus, Ohio 43215

614-752-8381

DASFACILITIESMGNT@das.ohio.gov

State of Ohio Administrative Policies may be found online at
<https://das.ohio.gov/home/policy-finder/filter-policy-finder>

VIII. Revision History

Date	Description of Change
01/12/2024	Original policy